[METRIC]

A-A-2123B
March 22, 1994
SUPERSEDES
A-A-2123A
November 18, 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

STENCIL, DUPLICATING MACHINE

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description, for all Federal Agencies.

1. Scope: This description covers paper stencils for use as masters in reproduction on mimeograph duplicating machines.

2. Salient characteristics:

2.1 The stencil paper size, as expressed by overall dimensions of the backing sheet, shall be 216 x 362mm (8-1/2 x 14-1/4 inches) or 216 x 457mm (8-1/2 x 18 inches) (+/- 1.6mm (1/16 inch)), as specified (See Ordering Data).

2.2 The stencil paper shall be a fibrous tissue treated with wet strength resins and coated with a blue stencil forming material. The stencil paper shall have an average dry tensile strength in each direction of 50 g/mm (2.8 pounds/inch) width, minimum, when tested in accordance with TAPPI T 404. The stencil paper shall have an average elongation of 5 percent maximum, when tested in accordance with TAPPI T 457. The backing sheet shall have an average basis weight of 89 g/m^2(60 pounds (25 x 38-500)), minimum, when tested in accordance with TAPPI T 410. The cushioning sheet may be coated or impregnated at the supplier's option. When specified, stencils shall have a top film of flexible plastic which shall permit cutting of the stencil and shall be transparent to the extent that stenciled characters are clearly visible.

2.3. Each sheet of stencil paper shall be secured to a backing sheet which is perforated across its width such that a paper stub remains attached to the stencil paper when the body of the backing sheet is removed. The top of the stub shall contain four holes, suitably spaced, for holding the stub in the duplicating machine. The stencil paper shall remain firmly attached to the stub during the duplicating process. The top film, when specified, shall be adhered to the stub portion of the backing sheet such that the film remains in place during cutting of the stencil but shall be easily removed without fiber displacement when the stencil is to be mounted on the duplicating machine. The film shall extend at least 6.35mm (1/4 inch) beyond the lowest horizontal guideline.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, N.Y. 10278.

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Classification designation to reflect such a proper

2.4 The stencil paper shall have markings, imprinted in white, to indicate horizontal spacing, margins, and scale numbers. The scale numbers, corresponding to line spaces on a typewriter, shall be 1 to 62 inclusive or 1 to 84 inclusive as applicable for the specified stencil paper size. Marginal markings shall be located 17.5mm (11/16 inch) +/- 1.6mm (1/16 inch) from and parallel to left and right edges of the stencil paper. The vertical space available for cutting the stencil shall be indicated by horizontal markings perpendicular to marginal markings. Additional guide markings are at the option of the supplier. Each twenty-four stencils shall be furnished with at least 8 coated or impregnated or 12 noncoated or non-impregnated cushioning sheets. Detailed instructions for stencil preparation shall be furnished with each package of stencils.

2.5 Bleaching: To obtain an acceptable brightness, in accordance with the performance standards of this document, a chemical bleaching process may be used. When specified in the ordering data (See Ordering Data), the bleaching process shall not include the use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, or other chlorine compounds. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to firsty delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

2.6 Workmanship. The end item shall be free of any defects such as, paper dust, grit spots, wrinkles, folds, holes, tears and smudges or any other defects that may affect appearance or serviceability. The edges of the end item shall not be nicked or uneven and shall be clean cut and lint free.

2.7 Performance. The stencils shall be capable of producing not less than 5000 copies without distortion or other failures that impair legibility. Cuts in the stencil paper shall be readily penetrated by the ink to give clear, legible copies uniform in depth of color. The stencil paper shall show no evidence of cutouts when the following is typed with an electric typewriter having clean, elite type and a soft, platen roll: a block of 300 small letter "e's", and the alphabet, both capital and small letters, repeating each letter not less than 10 times. The stencil paper shall show complete and uniform displacement of the coating without tearing or pulling the paper and without requiring a protective sheet when using a medium looped stylus. There shall be no noticeable difference in quality of duplication by stencils before and after application of correction fluid. The stencil paper shall retain its serviceability under normal storage conditions for not less than 12 months from time of deliver.

3. Quality Assurance Provisions. Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this commercial item description where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirement.

Sampling for examination and tests shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, using the plans as specified in Table 1, unless otherwise stated. For the purpose of sampling, a lot shall consist of duplicating machine stencils. The sample unit shall be 1 duplicating machine stencil for visual/workmanship and dimensional examination and one fully prepared shipping container for preparation for delivery examination, unless specified otherwise.

3.1 Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Descrition, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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Table I

Examine	Inspection Levels	AQLs (% defect)
Visual/Workmanship	I	2.5
Dimensional Defects	S-3	4.0
Paper Characteristics	TAPPI	N/A

3.2 Bleaching: To obtain an acceptable brightness, in accordance with the performance standards of this document, a chemical bleaching process may be used. When specified in the ordering data (See Ordering Data), the bleaching process shall not include the use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, or other chlorine compounds. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4. Regulatory requirements.

4.1 Certification. The contractor shall certify that the minimum content standard shall be no less than 50% recovered materials including 20% post consumer materials in accordance with Executive Order 12873, section 504 (b), dated October 20, 1993 (See definition of post consumer materials and recovered materials in sections 203 and 205). As an alternative to meeting the standards of section 504(b) for all printing and writing papers, the minimum content standard shall be no less than 50% recovered materials that are a waste material byproduct of a finished product other than a paper or textile product which would otherwise be disposed of in a landfill, as determined by the State in which the facility is located, in accordance with Executive Order 12873, section 504 (c), dated October 20, 1993. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4.2 Labeling. The recycled content shall be marked on the product or unit pack.

5. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

6. Application for copies of technical documents referenced herein: The issue date in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall be apply.

(1) TAPPI test methods are available from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, P.O. Box 105113, Atlanta, GA 30348.
(2) MIL-STD-105 is available from Standardization Documents Order Desk, Bldg. 4D, 700 Robbins Ave., Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.
(3) Copies of Executive Order 12873, dated October 20, 1993 may be obtained from: The White House Publications Office, New Executive Office Building,White House, Att: Publications,Washington, DC. 20500 (202) 395-7332

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7. Ordering Data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

A) Dimensions.
B) Whether bleaching without use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, or chlorine compound is required.
C) Packaging, packing, labeling and marking.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

DOD has waived coordination of this document

PREPARING ACTIVITY:
GSA-FSS

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